

Brian Kilpatrick

Technology Delivery & Operations Leader | Engineering Director | Delivery, Governance & Scaling | Project Management

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Profile

Senior technology delivery and operations leader with over 13 years' experience progressing from software engineering into Director-level roles, leading distributed teams delivering complex enterprise platforms to global customers.

Strong focus on delivery execution, governance, and operational structure, with a proven track record of improving release predictability, scaling teams, and introducing clarity across multi-disciplinary environments. Experienced in coordinating engineering, product, and business stakeholders to ensure delivery outcomes are aligned to organisational priorities.

Trusted partner to senior stakeholders during periods of organisational change, including external audit, operational restructuring, and product divestiture, providing clear insight into delivery performance, risk, and operational readiness.

Recognised as a pragmatic and people-focused leader, bringing structure, control, and stability to complex delivery and operational challenges. Particularly interested in roles focused on scaling operations, strengthening governance, and supporting organisational growth within fast-moving technology environments.

Core Strengths

- Delivery leadership across distributed environments
- Operational governance, structure, and scaling
- Programme delivery, risk and issue management
- Release governance and delivery predictability
- Stakeholder and customer engagement at senior level
- Organisational change and restructuring
- Cross-functional leadership (Engineering, Product, QA, Security)
- External audit, governance and operational due diligence
- Global team leadership (UK, US, Europe, India, South America)
- People leadership, coaching and performance management

Experience

Director of Engineering - Cirata / WANDisco PLC, Belfast (July 2024 - Dec 2025)

Led a global engineering organisation of approximately 30 engineers across multiple product lines, with five direct reports across distributed teams. Accountable for software delivery, engineering performance, and release quality across enterprise platforms used by global customers.

- Provided local leadership for the Belfast site, supporting operational coordination, employee experience, H&S, and communication during periods of organisational change
- Led engineering delivery across multiple teams, ensuring high-quality releases and improved delivery predictability across distributed environments
- Established structured delivery practices and release governance, contributing to a shift from infrequent, delayed releases to consistent quarterly delivery cycles
- Worked closely with Product, QA, and senior engineering leadership to align delivery plans, priorities, and technical direction
- Oversaw release planning, production readiness, and delivery risk across multiple workstreams, maintaining delivery continuity during periods of organisational change
- Managed engineering team performance, capacity planning, and team structure across multiple locations
- Supported external audits and operational due diligence, contributing engineering insight and delivery data to senior stakeholders
- Played a key role in maintaining delivery stability during product divestiture and organisational restructuring

Senior Manager / Engineering Manager - Cirata / WANDisco PLC (2022 - 2024)

Led multiple engineering teams with responsibility for recruitment, retention, and performance management. Coached engineers and managers, supporting career growth and leadership development. Improved delivery outcomes through close collaboration with Product and Testing leadership.

Project Manager / Scrum Master - Cirata / WANDisco PLC (2018 - 2022)

Scrum Master for multiple distributed engineering teams across Belfast, the US, UK and St Petersburg. Played a central role in the transition from Waterfall delivery to Agile and Scrum across the organisation.

Introduced structured sprint planning, backlog governance and delivery metrics which improved delivery predictability. Increased release cadence from one to two delayed releases per year to four predictable quarterly releases delivered consistently on time or early.

Senior Software Developer / Software Developer - Cirata / WANDisco PLC (2014 - 2018)

Senior technical contributor on Java-based enterprise ALM products supporting Subversion and Git repositories. Strong involvement in build and release processes. Led a remote automation team across South America and later India, coordinating delivery and reporting to senior leadership.

QA Engineer / Junior QA Engineer - Cirata / WANDisco PLC (2013 - 2014)

Contributed to quality assurance for core ALM products within Agile teams. Took on early leadership responsibility managing a remote team in Chennai, India.

Professional Development

Expanding practical use of AI-assisted development to understand how emerging tools can improve engineering productivity, delivery, and operational effectiveness, supported by building a small personal security-focused product

Also currently undertaking structured cyber security training via TryHackMe, focusing on security fundamentals, threat analysis, and SOC-level concepts working towards Security Analyst Level 2 (SAL2) as a goal.

Building practical understanding of security operations, vulnerabilities, and governance frameworks to complement experience in delivery, audit, and operational oversight.

Further studying AI in Project Management training with The Knowledge Academy, with ongoing application of AI tooling to improve delivery, analysis and workflow efficiency

Education and Certifications

University of Ulster - 2013
Foundation Degree Software Development

Liverpool John Moores University - 2007
BA (Hons) Business Management

PRINCE2 v7 Foundation and Practitioner - 2026

Change Management v3 Foundation and Practitioner - 2026

CSM Certified Scrum Master

References

Available upon request